

Of course, extracting a binary file wouldn't do most users any good when it comes to modifying the content.

Still, if you do want to fiddle around with the content after backing it up, you could uncheck the 'Binary backup' option. This creates an Excel-like CSV file in the PIB backup, taking up much a lot more space but being easily editable.

It would be wise to take a binary backup first, and then a CSV backup as well to store remotely on your PC.

And yes, PIM Backup is robust enough to offer an automatic backup scheduler for the forgetful types among us. You can set the day and time on which the program will run, and even choose to delete old files if necessary.

Of course, if you use this feature often, it will invariably use up a lot of disk space with the numerous backup files. Not to worry: A convenient feature lets you choose the number of old backup files to keep, ensuring that you're constantly updated with minimal strain on your handset.

The Restore procedure is just as simple as the backup. Just fire up the feature, browse to the file from the date you want to backup, and hit 'Next' a couple of times. Hopefully, you won't have to use this feature often as it takes up a lot of time, going up to an hour!

But hey, given the peace of mind it offers, it's totally worth it.

Platforms: Windows Mobile

Price: Free

Download: www.dotfred.net

SyncMate

Windows Mobile to OSX, as easy as pie!

It's funny. The iPhone has sold several million units worldwide and Mac users are known to be fiercely loyal to all Apple products. Yet, a lot of such Mac fanatics – especially in India – are opting for Windows Mobile-based cell phones. Reasons among the lot we know vary from "The camera isn't good enough" and "I want a keypad" to "Dude, it's just way too expensive".

The conflict does lead to a significant problem for these users: syncing their WinMob handsets to their Mac OSX computer.

A cool tool that achieves this task with ease and grace